



Women & POC in Tech

Golden Idea

As a minority group in tech, there are additional resources you need to take advantage of to maximize your opportunity to land a job or internship in software engineering. Here's what a "minority" in tech is and what resources to use depending on which group you fall into.

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What is a minority? Official definition.

A **minority** refers to a group of people who are distinct from the larger population in terms of ethnicity, race, religion, gender, or other characteristics, and who often hold less power, representation, or influence in a society. The term generally applies to groups that face social, economic, or political disadvantages or underrepresentation compared to the majority group.

Here's a list of 10 most common minorities in society:

1. **Black/African American**
2. **Hispanic/Latino**
3. **Native Americans/Indigenous Peoples**
4. **Asian Americans**
5. **Pacific Islanders**
6. **Women**
7. **LGBTQ+ Individuals**
8. **People with Disabilities**
9. **Religious Minorities (e.g., Muslims, Jews, Sikhs)**
10. **Immigrants and Refugees**

What is a minority in tech? Members of this list who are underrepresented in the world of tech and software engineering.

1. **Black/African Americans in Tech**
2. **Hispanic/Latino Americans in Tech**
3. **Women in Tech**
4. **Native Americans/Indigenous Peoples in Tech**
5. **LGBTQ+ Individuals in Tech**

While Asians are considered a minority and a POC in general society, **they are not considered a minority in tech.**

If you don't belong to at least one of the 5 groups listed above, then you don't need to watch this video, you can skip ahead to the next videos.



Why Do Tech Companies Prioritize Minorities in Tech?

Tech companies offer additional aid to minorities to address the significant underrepresentation of these groups in the industry.

Historically, women, people of color, and other marginalized communities have faced barriers to entering and succeeding in tech roles due to systemic inequities in education, access to resources, and opportunities.

By providing additional support—such as scholarships, mentorship programs, targeted recruitment, and career development opportunities—tech companies aim to level the playing field and ensure that talented individuals from underrepresented backgrounds can contribute and thrive in the industry.

This is a sensitive topic — to be honest, I don't care about why they do it or the morals/ethics behind it. I just know that they do it and as your coach, my #1 priority is to help you succeed — and by leveraging resources for minorities, you significantly improve your shot of getting hired.

How Does Being a Minority Affect Your Prospects?

It's simple — if you utilize the fact that you're a minority and take advantage of that, you're a lot more likely to land that first round interview. Companies want to hire more from your group, so by leaning into that you can land interviews at a faster rate.



Tactics

1. Join As Many Orgs + Events As Possible For Your Group

- This is the most powerful. These groups #1 objective is to get you interviews — so if you qualify, you HAVE TO JOIN.
- These conferences and groups often have special application links for companies that get you past the first round — it works wonders.
- These are some examples, though there are probably a lot more — so do your research and try to join as many as possible. You also want to be an active participant.

Women + LGBTQ+

- ☐ **Rewriting The Code**
- ☐ **Grace Hopper**
 - Try to go in person if possible, but if not, then you need to go online. It's expensive but worth it.
- ☐ **ACM-W**

Minority Hackathons

There are some hackathons exclusively for minorities — join those if possible!

Black + Latino

☐ National Society of Black Engineers

☐ ColorStack

- You need to apply to this and they are known to reject people — so put effort into your application, as much as you would for a scholarship or actual position.
- They'll ask you to select your race — if you belong to multiple groups as well as Black, then just select Black. Trust me. I want you to get in.

2. Add Them To Your Resume

- You'll want to add these to your resume near the top. Recruiters are more likely to pass you if they see them because they are actively trying to hire from these groups.

3. Network At These Events/Groups

- Again — don't sleep on these. Utilize them to their maximum potential. Set up coffee chats with all the successful individuals in them. They want to help you, so use them. Get referrals, advice, insights, etc.
- These events also have career fairs where applications even open up early for you. It's a super powerful resource, and YOU CANNOT SKIP OUT.

4. Company / University Events

- There are sometimes company specific events for minorities — you want to lean into those as much as possible.
- ACM-W is University based, and sometimes schools have additional groups or resources you can utilize.

Next Steps

Right now apply for as many of these as you possibly can — and do some real research to find out more of them and get into as many as possible.